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Applied Computer Architecture

Writing Assignment 1

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Concept 1: Describe how to open the computer case properly and safely.

When opening a computer case, you should always protect yourself and the computer's components. Remove your jewelry to avoid transferring electrical charge to your body. Backup the data to prevent losing essential data. Drain the system's power by pressing and holding the power button for three seconds, then unplug it without forgetting the peripherals. Be careful not to get injured by the sharp edges of the computer's case. You should never remove the cover or put your hands inside the monitor or power supply because you can get an electric shock if you do so. Use an ESD strap or ground mat unless it is around a high-voltage environment because, in such an environment, you could be the path for this current (high-voltage). Lastly, always plan and organize the tools you will need and place equipment in an antistatic bag.

Concept 2: Describe what ESD is, the harmful effect it has on a PC and/or data, and how to protect computer equipment and/or data.

Electrostatic discharge (ESD) occurs when a static charge causes two objects to have different electrical potentials build up. ESD can harm PCs and data by causing a catastrophic failure, which can destroy the component, or by causing an upset failure, which can damage the component and reduce its efficiency. Both failures can permanently affect the device. To protect computer equipment and data against ESD, always apply static control methods: ESD straps, ESD mats, static shielding bags, and ESD gloves. If used properly, these methods will equalize the static charges between you and the case. Besides these methods, there are other precautions to take: never work on a carpet, avoid cold and dry atmospheres, remove any material that attracts ESD, keep the components inside antistatic bags before using them, and keep them away from hair and clothing.

Concept 3: - Describe appropriate ways to deal with customers.

As a PC technician, sometimes you will deal with excellent customers, but other times you will not. When encountering challenging situations, one of the crucial rules is always to be professional and keep a positive and helpful attitude. Customers can get frustrated when facing technical problems, and the best way to respond to them is by not being defensive or dismissive but instead acknowledging their concerns and asking questions to be sure of the issue. Keep calm, avoid arguments, and never complain about this situation on social media. It is essential to listen to customers without interrupting them and then show confidence by clearly explaining, with no industry jargon, every step that will be taken. Always record your work and test the software and equipment after finishing to ensure everything works fine. Also, ask the customer for additional questions to ensure satisfaction. Finally, if concerns are outside your expertise, help the customer or contact the appropriate people.

